Bank of Leeds Infrastructure Investment Proposal

Yorkshire Maritime Network 2045

A £2.6 Billion Programme to Create a Distributed Maritime Economy Across Yorkshire

Prepared for:
Bank of Leeds – Infrastructure, Industrial & Regional Growth Division

Investment Classification:
Strategic Infrastructure / Regional Economic Development

Investment Horizon:
25–40 years

Executive Summary

The Bank of Leeds proposes the creation of the **Yorkshire Maritime Network**, a coordinated investment programme designed to transform Yorkshire's relationship with the sea, inland waterways and global trade routes.

Rather than attempting to compete directly with major container ports such as Felixstowe, Liverpool or Immingham, the strategy is based upon creating a **specialised network of complementary maritime assets**:

- **Hull** – international trade gateway and export hub
- **Goole –** inland logistics and manufacturing port
- **Scarborough –** offshore energy and blue economy hub
- **Whitby** – premium maritime tourism and seafood economy
- **Selby** – inland river freight and industrial logistics

The programme would combine:

- port infrastructure,
- logistics parks,
- rail freight,
- renewable energy,
- tourism,
- marine technology,
- manufacturing.

The objective is to create:

- 25,000+ jobs,
- £10bn+ additional economic activity,
- a resilient Yorkshire supply chain,
- a new maritime identity for the region.

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1. Strategic Investment Thesis

The Problem

Yorkshire possesses one of Britain's most valuable geographic assets:

- North Sea coastline,
- Humber estuary access,
- manufacturing heritage,
- major population centres,
- industrial land.

However, much of Yorkshire's maritime economy remains fragmented.

Current limitations:

- limited coastal investment outside Hull,
- insufficient east-west freight connections,
- underdeveloped coastal tourism assets,
- weak integration between ports and inland manufacturing.

The Opportunity

Create a Yorkshire equivalent of:

- Dutch port clusters,
- Norwegian maritime innovation zones,
- Danish coastal industrial networks.

The proposal is not one port.

It is:

"A Yorkshire Maritime System"

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2. Investment Overview

Total Programme Cost

£2.6 Billion

Asset	Investment
Goole Logistics Port Expansion	£600m
Scarborough Blue Economy Port	£650m
Whitby Maritime Tourism Development	£250m
Selby River Freight Terminal	£300m
Hull Strategic Partnership	£500m
Network Infrastructure & Digital Systems	£300m

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3. Project One

Goole Strategic Logistics Port

Investment: £600 million

Vision

Transform Goole into Yorkshire's inland logistics gateway.

Goole already benefits from:

- connection to the Humber,
- rail infrastructure,
- motorway access,
- industrial land availability.

The proposal creates:

Yorkshire Inland Container Port

Development

Container Terminal

Capacity:

250,000 TEU annually

Investment:

£200m

Rail Freight Terminal

New facilities:

- container handling
- warehousing
- manufacturing connections

Investment:

£150m

Industrial Logistics Park

Development:

3 million sq ft

Investment:

£200m

Digital Logistics Platform

Investment:

£50m

Economic Impact

Jobs:

5,000 direct and indirect

Annual economic output:

£600m+

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4. Project Two

Scarborough Blue Economy Port

Investment: £650 million

Vision

Create Yorkshire's premier marine technology and offshore energy hub.

Scarborough should not attempt to become a container port.

Its opportunity is:

- offshore wind,
- marine engineering,
- robotics,
- tourism,
- research.

Development Programme

Offshore Wind Support Base

Investment:

£250m

Facilities:

- vessel servicing
- component storage
- engineering workshops

Marine Technology Campus

Investment:

£150m

Tenants:

- robotics companies
- universities
- environmental technology firms

Luxury Maritime District

Investment:

£150m

Includes:

- marina expansion
- restaurants
- hotels
- conference facilities

Coastal Research Centre

Investment:

£100m

Focus:

- North Sea ecology
- offshore technology
- marine engineering

Economic Impact

Jobs:

7,500

Annual output:

£900m+

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5. Project Three

Whitby Maritime Heritage & Tourism Port

Investment: £250 million

Vision

Transform Whitby into Britain's leading heritage maritime destination.

Not a cargo port.

A premium visitor economy asset.

Development

Luxury Marina Expansion

£100m

Capacity:

+500 berths

Seafood & Fishing Quarter

£50m

Includes:

- modern fish market
- restaurants
- visitor centre

Heritage Cruise Terminal

£50m

Target:

- boutique cruises
- North Sea voyages
- expedition tourism

Marine Enterprise Hub

£50m

Economic Impact

Visitors:

+750,000 annually

Jobs:

3,000

Additional tourism spending:

£200m/year

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6. Project Four

Selby River Freight Terminal

Investment: £300 million

Vision

Create a Yorkshire inland waterway logistics hub.

Uses

- construction materials
- aggregates
- timber
- recycling
- agricultural products

Development:

River terminal:

£100m

Rail connection:

£100m

Warehousing:

£100m

Economic Impact:

Jobs:

2,000

Annual output:

£300m

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7. Hull Strategic Partnership

Investment: £500 million

The Bank of Leeds would not seek to replace Hull's existing port operators.

Instead:

create a strategic investment partnership.

Investment areas:

Export Manufacturing Zone

£200m

Industries:

- renewable energy
- engineering
- food production

Port Digitalisation

£100m

Technology:

- AI logistics
- automation
- customs systems

Rail Freight Expansion

£200m

Connecting:

Hull

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Goole

↓

Leeds

↓

Sheffield

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8. Yorkshire Maritime Rail Spine

Investment: £300 million

A dedicated freight strategy linking:

Hull

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Goole

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Selby

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Leeds

↓

Sheffield

Benefits:

- lower logistics costs
- fewer HGV journeys
- stronger manufacturing exports

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9. Financial Model

Revenue Streams

Port Operations

£150m annually

Logistics Property

10 million sq ft developed

Rental income:

£120m annually

Tourism

Scarborough + Whitby:

£100m annually

Renewable Energy Services

£150m annually

Total Stabilised Revenue

£520 million annually

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10. Five-Year Financial Forecast

Year	Revenue	EBITDA
Year 1	£80m	£10m
Year 2	£180m	£35m
Year 3	£300m	£70m
Year 4	£420m	£110m
Year 5	£520m	£160m

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11. Funding Structure

Yorkshire Maritime Investment Fund

Target:

£2.6 Billion

Capital Structure:

Source	Amount
Bank of Leeds	£750m
UK Infrastructure Funding	£700m
Pension Funds	£600m
Private Investors	£550m

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12. Wider Economic Impact

GDP Impact

Estimated additional regional economic activity:

£2–3 billion annually

through:

- improved logistics,
- manufacturing growth,
- tourism,
- offshore energy.

Employment Impact

Construction:

30,000 job-years

Permanent:

25,000 jobs

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13. Strategic Alignment

The proposal supports:

Net Zero

- offshore wind supply chains
- rail freight
- lower-carbon logistics

Levelling Up

- coastal regeneration
- northern productivity growth
- regional employment

Industrial Strategy

- advanced manufacturing
- energy security
- export growth

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14. Risk Assessment

Risk: Competition from Established Ports

Mitigation

Do not compete directly with Liverpool or Immingham.

Focus on specialist markets.

Risk: Coastal Planning Constraints

Mitigation

Prioritise brownfield and existing harbour areas.

Risk: Demand Risk

Mitigation

Develop phased investment.

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15. Investment Recommendation

The Bank of Leeds should establish:

Yorkshire Maritime Infrastructure Fund

with an initial commitment of:

£750 million

focused on:

1. Goole logistics expansion.
2. Scarborough blue economy development.
3. Whitby tourism transformation.
4. Hull export partnership.
5. Selby inland freight.

Final Investment Thesis

Yorkshire does not need another giant container port.

It needs a **connected maritime economy**.

By linking coastal assets, inland logistics, renewable energy and tourism, the Yorkshire Maritime Network could transform the region from a historic industrial centre into a modern North Sea economic powerhouse.

Bank of Leeds Strategic Objective:

> "Reconnect Yorkshire with the world through ports, people and prosperity."